

07. CHRONOLOGY, GROWTH, SYNCHRONICITIES

DURATION : 03:59

STUDY SHEET

COURSE SUMMARY

In this video, we explore the essential concepts of Biodynamic Embryology, focusing on the timeline of embryonic development, from the earliest stages of conception to the major transformations of the second month. We distinguish between motility, intrinsic to the tissue, and mobility, linked to respiration, highlighting the importance of treating the environment rather than just the organs. Notions of potency within the tissue and the importance of the diaphragm are also discussed, offering therapists tools to work effectively with embryonic movement and growth.

BIODYNAMIC EMBRYOLOGY: CHRONOLOGY, GROWTH, SYNCHRONICITY

DEFINING THE EMBRYO: DAYS, CARNEGIE, AND GROWTH

To understand the **embryo**, we can define it in terms of **days** or according to the **Carnegie stages**. In this course, we will focus on days.

When **synchronised** phenomena occur, such as the closure of the **neuropores** or the integration of the **coeloms**, we will give you precise points in time, for example, at the moment of the **heart's** awareness. Otherwise, we will speak in days or weeks, and we will also address notions of **size**.

What is truly important for you is the notion of **growth**. You must understand that the embryo is a **developmental movement**. It is a movement that develops from the inside out, and not the other way around.

MOTILITY AND MOBILITY: TWO DISTINCT MOVEMENTS

This is the fundamental difference between what we call **motility** and **mobility**:

- **Motility** is an embryonic response. It follows the movement of the intrinsic development of the tissue.
- **Mobility** is a movement purely related to respiration and motor function.

It is crucial to make this distinction clear. When I move my arm, it is very different from the intrinsic movement at the level of my **liver**.

If I want to rework a tissue, I bring it back into its motility. This is where its **functional force** lies, where it will reorganise itself. This is the work we do: to return to this tissue so that it can reorganise and regain its mobility.

It is always about following the movement, but for that, you need **points of support** and to have the movement in your hand.

TREATING THE ENVIRONMENT, NOT JUST THE ORGAN

I do not treat an **organ**, I treat an **environment**. However, my action can sometimes influence mobility and motor function.

In the context of mobility, the master is the **diaphragm**. That is why we will learn how this diaphragm is built.

THE POWER OF TISSUE: A REVELATION

One day, my teacher told me: "Marc, one day you will feel the **power** in the tissue." For me, this power was very intellectual. I could understand that a developing embryo represents incredible power, a movement that never stops.

He also told me that sometimes, in **"stillness"** (moments of immobility), in certain points of support, this power is also present. It is incredible, and at that moment, something happens. However, you cannot create this all the time. You have to try to be present, to have a good connection, and at some point, the system adjusts.

He gave me an image: "It's as if you were in a small boat in the sea. You are just in the water, and you don't see it, but beneath you, a **whale** is coming. And you feel, you feel all of a sudden, it's a bit like that sensation."

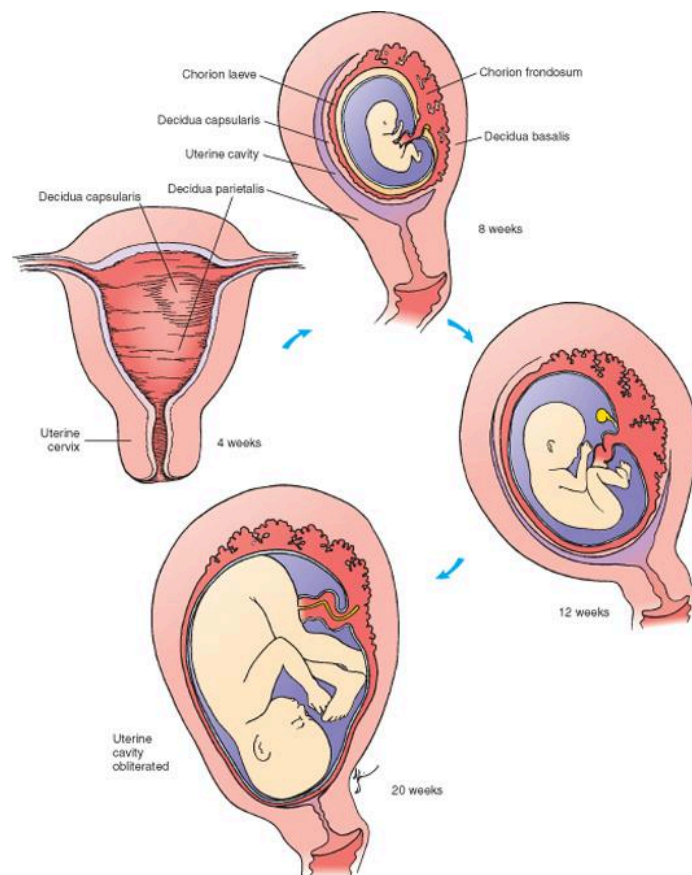
FROM OVUM TO SECOND MONTH: AN INCREDIBLE TRANSFORMATION

Look at what we are on the first day: a small **mess**. And look at what will happen at the end of the **second month**. In just two months, an incredible transformation takes place.

From the beginning of the **twentieth day**, a form is already beginning to take shape. The potential for life is there.

Initially, it is simply an **ovum** that has received the genetic heritage from the father, the **sperm**. The two heritages are meeting. This is roughly the first image of your life.

We then observe what is called the **zona pellucida** and **nurse cells**. There are several important layers of cells that are being put in place.



Schoenwolf et al: Larsen's Human Embryology, 4th Edition.
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FIG. — *Fetal uterine development*

Carnegie Stages of Human Development

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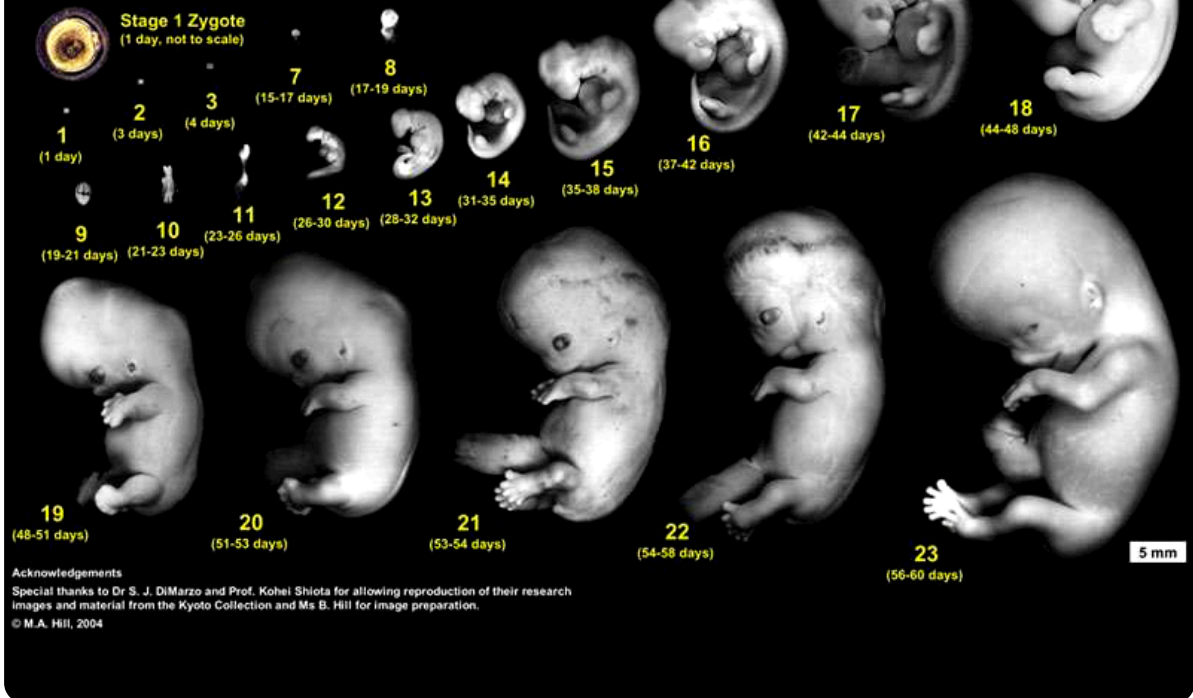


FIG. — Human embryonic development

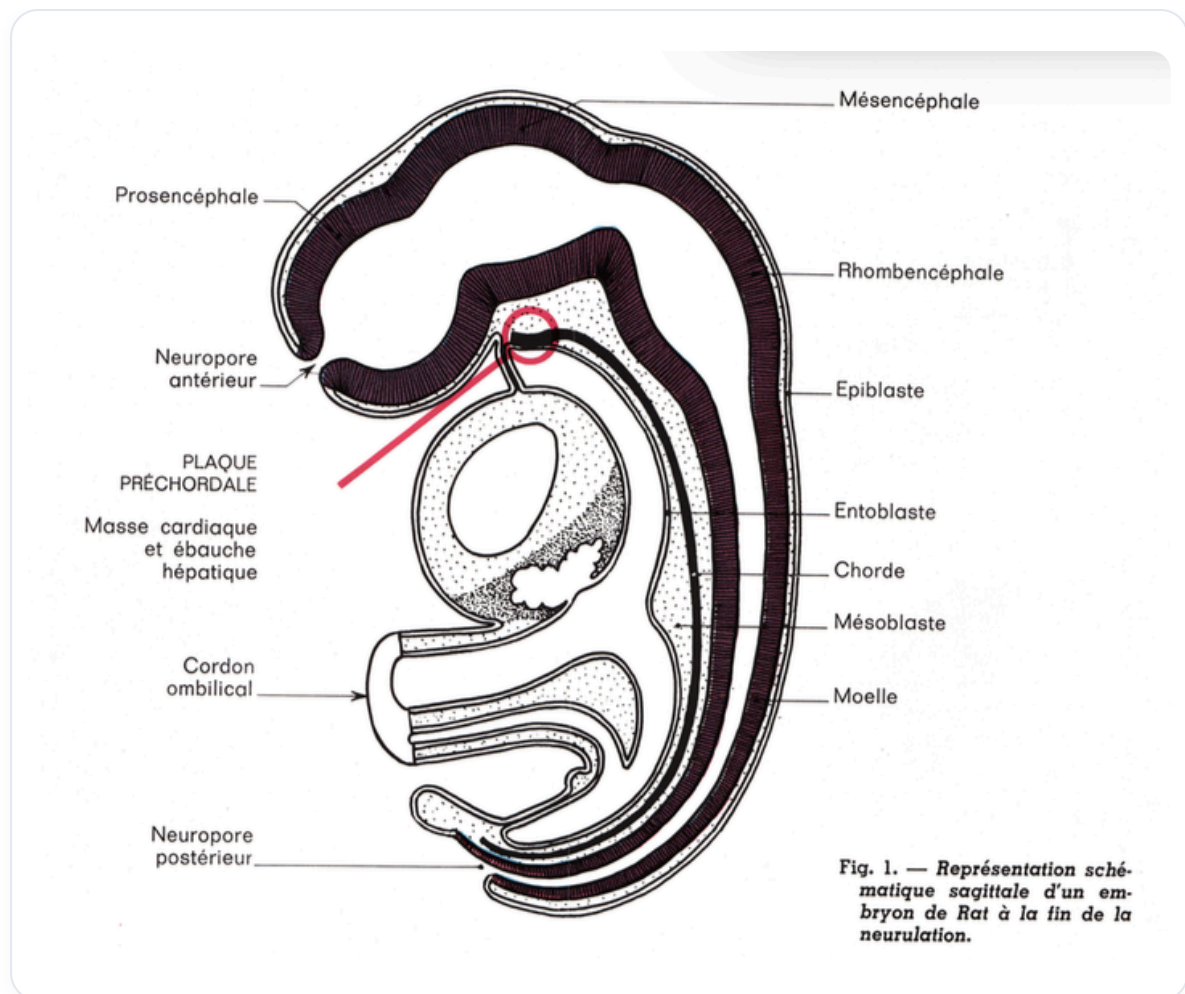


FIG. — Embryo sagittal neurulation

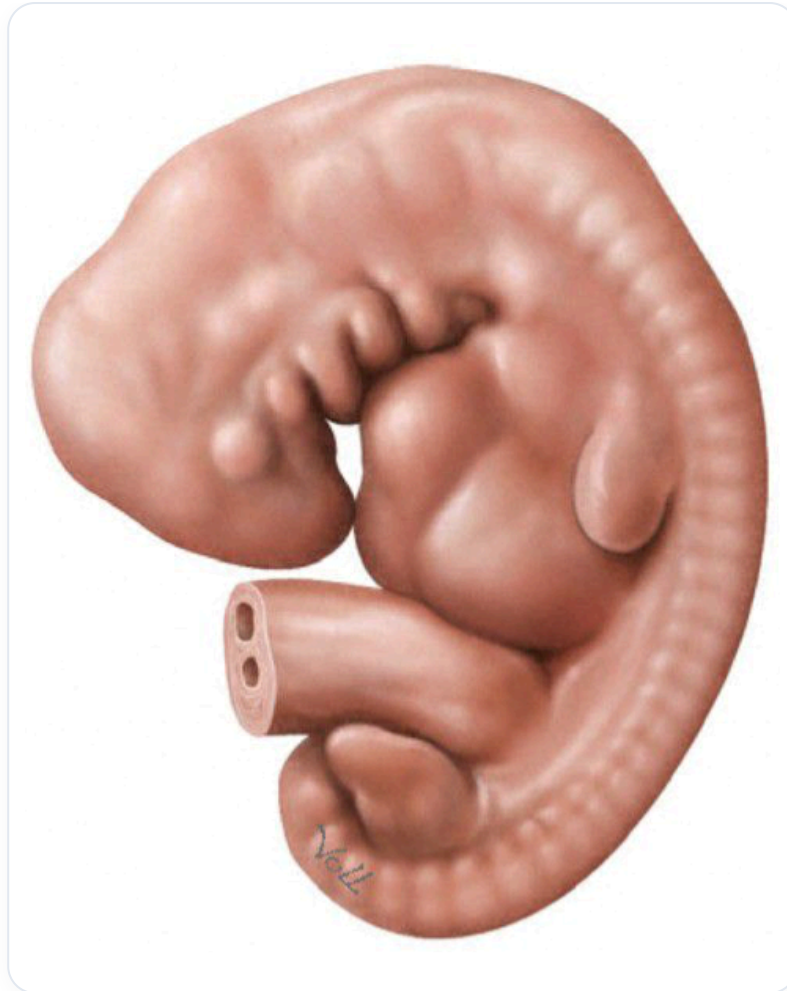


FIG. — *Embryo, 6-7 weeks*